Ronald E. Straight

Senior Software Engineer

I bring decades of experience in high-performance backend engineering, from C and Perl to modern Golang and Kubernetes-native Java and Rust microservices.

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github.com/ronstr8

ronstr8 (LinkedIn)

ronstr8 (GitHub)

Work

Senior Software Engineer

Synacor
Feb 2019 – Oct 2024
Buffalo, NY

- Owned the Golang-based Mailbox Locator Service, an integral part of converting the Zimbra email/collaboration system to a multi-tenant Kubernetes-native service on Oracle Cloud Infrastructure.
- Owned a self-service onboarding and management system for Zimbra built in Java with Dropwizard and hosted on Kubernetes, utilizing OAuth, supporting recurring subscription payments, providing site management and reports.
- Leveraged Golang and Kubernetes expertise to migrate several hundred million user mailboxes — containing sensitive personal communications — from bare-metal servers to Zimbra on Kubernetes, maintaining data integrity throughout.

Senior Software Engineer

Adblade / Solve Media
May 2013 – Jan 2019
Buffalo, NY

- Owned a high-availability RESTful Data Management Platform (DMP) using Java/Netty, supporting sub-millisecond responses at scale.
- Developed custom dispatching annotations and supported multiple HTTP methods for consumer targeting resources stored in Redis.
- Ported a legacy image conversion REST server from Ruby to Java and migrated a Solaris data center environment to AWS.

Software Engineer III, Team Leader

Kanoodle / Pulse360 / Seevast
Nov 2004 – Apr 2013
Buffalo, NY

- Contributed Oracle-specific enhancements upstream to the DBIx::Class open-source ORM framework while developing heavy Perl ad-serving applications.
- Performed Oracle DBA duties, including DDL review and Oracle analytic functions.
- Owned a 'RoboDeploy' system for multi-threaded deployment to over 100 servers.

Co-Founder, Software Developer

Netsville
Jun 1994 – Nov 2004
Rochester, NY

- Co-founded Netsville and developed 'Hazel,' one of the first e-commerce checkout systems, written in POSIX C with a templating language (HZML).

Projects

Logodal

Jan 2026 – Present

Multiplayer whimsical word game running on a kind cluster in my bedroom. In active development.

- Developed a custom wordlist server in Rust to handle building lexicons and their rules for any language.
- Configured networking and TLS termination for public access to the local Kubernetes cluster at logodal.com.
- Implemented real-time gameplay mechanics using Perl, plus simple intelligent dummy players.
- Use in-cluster ollama to generate personalized quips for the AI players

Kubernetes Minikube Helm Perl Rust React Networking Antigravity Claude Codex

Card Shoggoths

Jan 2026 – Present

Multiplayer poker game with a bit of cosmic horror. In active development.

- Implemented the game server in Golang, with a bare bones index.html/css frontend.
- Configured networking for public access to the local Kubernetes cluster at poker.fazigu.org.

Kubernetes Minikube Helm Golang Networking Antigravity

Skills

Programming Languages

Bash Java Perl Golang C

Technologies

Kubernetes Git HTML CSS

Python Rust Javascript REST API OCI AWS Helm Docker Node.js LLM

Databases

Oracle MySQL PostgreSQL MariaDB Redis MongoDB

Frameworks

Netty Dropwizard React Spring Boot

AI

Claude Code Codex Aider Antigravity Paperclip

Interests

Personal Interests

Hacking (in the ESR sense) Tinkering with gadgets Fallout/76, Starfield, Cyberpunk 2077 Arguing with AI The Love Boat